

How to Build a Portfolio as a Creative

Showcasing your best work

@Ojimaajo__

Housekeeping rules

1

Please stay muted and use the chat for interaction unless when called on or during discussions

2

You can stop me and ask if you have any questions

3

Feel free to post what you're learning on social media and tag me @ojimaojo__

4

In a noisy environment and need to ask a question? Drop a message.

What are we discussing?

Topics Covered

1

Importance of a portfolio

2

Elements of a portfolio

3

How to build a portfolio

4

Storytelling in portfolios

5

Choosing the right work samples

Hey, It's Ojay

- I am a Content Creator, Social Media Marketer, and Public Relations Associate,
- I am based in Lagos Nigeria.
- **My expectation** - Everyone on this call should leave with clarity for their careers. This class should be a kickstart for everything you have been overthinking. **This class should equip you to DO.**





**Why don't you have a
portfolio?**

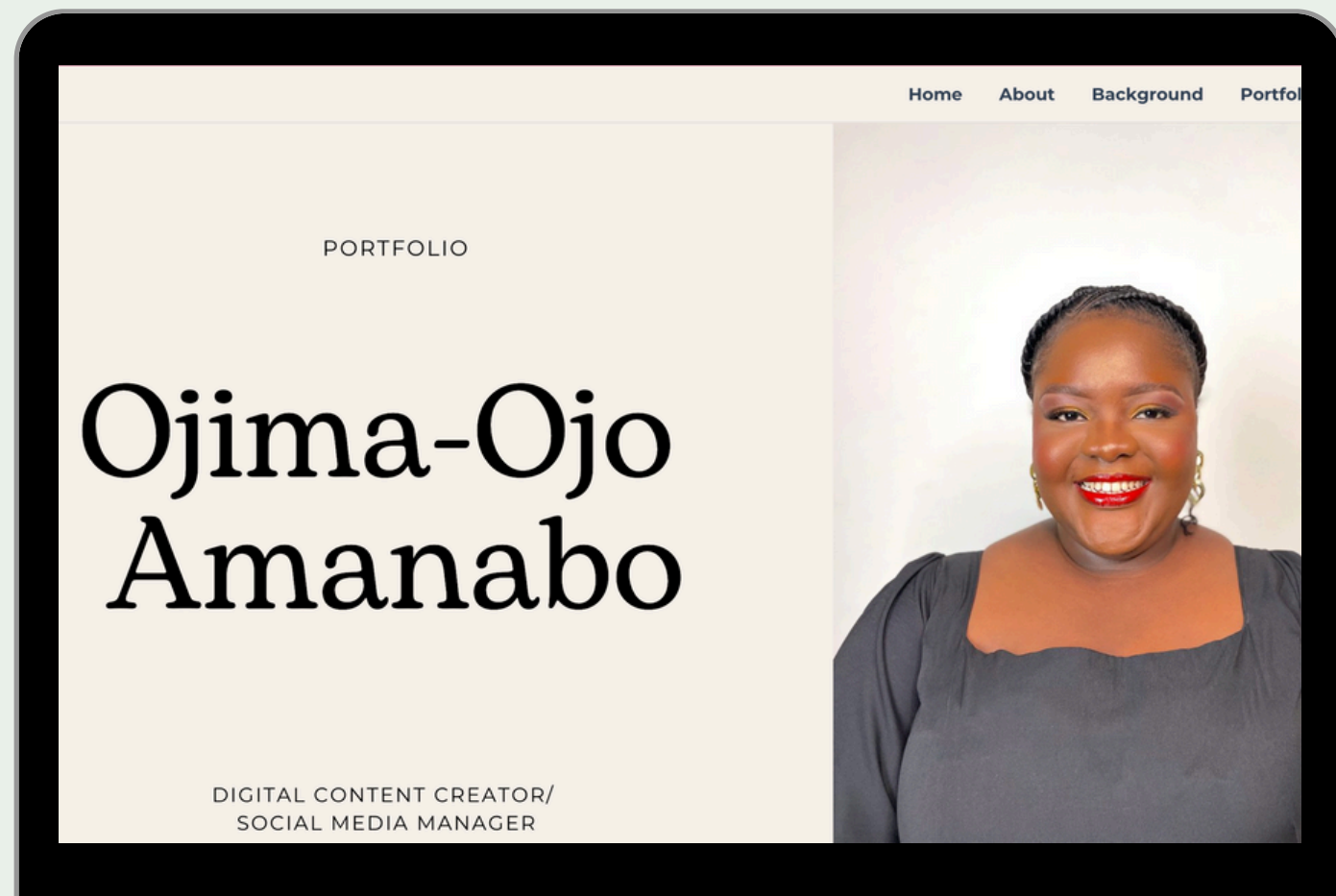
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What is a portfolio?

A portfolio is a curated collection of your work, skills, and accomplishments.

It showcases your expertise, creativity, and professional achievements in a structured and visually engaging way.

Portfolios are essential for demonstrating your abilities to potential employers, clients, or collaborators.





71% of employers strongly agree that a portfolio's quality will influence their decision to hire a candidate.

— Hover Blog, 2017.

Importance of a portfolio

- **Demonstrates Skills and Experience:** A portfolio offers a visual and tangible way to showcase your skills and work experience beyond a resume.
- **Helps You Stand Out:** In competitive fields, a strong portfolio distinguishes you by showing proof of your abilities and unique style.
- **Aids Career Growth:** Having a portfolio shows potential employers or clients how you've evolved professionally, making you a strong candidate for new opportunities.

Tools for creating a good portfolio



Canva



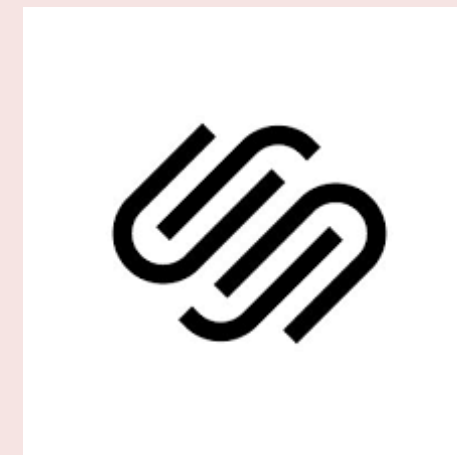
Behance



Dribbble



Journo



Squarespace



Notion



Wordpress

Canva Demo

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Element of a Portfolio



Bio/Introduction:

Position yourself (who you are, what you do, who you do it for, why people should hire you).



Work Samples

Showcase your best work (quality over quantity). What if I don't have work samples



Services Offered

What you can do for potential clients/employers. What can you do

Element of a Portfolio



Testimonials/Client Feedback

Credibility boosters.



Contact Information

How people can reach you.

Brief Task

Draft your bio, let's make changes

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Break time – 20 mins

Drink water, share what you are learning on socials, and get some snacks.

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Portfolio Structure

Organize by Clients

- This structure focuses on presenting your work based on the clients or companies you've worked with.
- It highlights the projects you've completed for each client in a separate section.
- **When to Use It:**
- Ideal if you've worked with recognizable brands or large companies.
- Effective for showcasing diverse projects within specific industries.

Portfolio Structure

Organize by Skill

- This structure highlights your core competencies or services, grouping your portfolio by the different types of skills you bring to the table, such as content marketing, social media management, SEO, or design.

When to Use It:

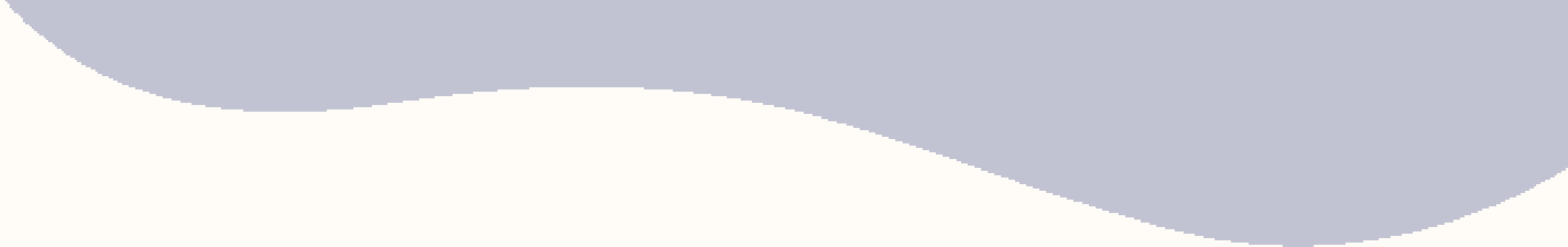
- Perfect for freelancers, generalists, or multi-skilled professionals.
- Ideal if you want to demonstrate versatility across different industries or project types.

Case Study

Look at your portfolio as a story -

Every story has a hero, with a problem they are trying to solve, with a solution, and at the end - the results. This is where case studies come in.





Case Studies in Portfolios

A case study is a detailed account of a specific project, campaign, or problem you worked on, showcasing your role in delivering results. It offers proof of your skills, approach, and ability to solve challenges.



Why Case studies?



Demonstrates Problem-Solving Skills

Case studies show how you think and act to resolve real-world problems.

Provides Tangible Results

They showcase measurable outcomes that can build credibility with clients or employers.

Builds Trust

Highlighting a successful case study boosts confidence in your abilities, showing potential clients or employers that you can deliver results.

Structure of an Effective Case Study

Problem

- Define the challenge or issue you faced. Be specific.
- Example: "The client was struggling to engage their social media audience, resulting in low follower growth and poor engagement metrics."

Solution

- Describe the steps you took to solve the problem. Focus on your strategy, tools, and techniques.
- Example: "I developed a tailored content strategy based on audience insights, including weekly social media posts, contests, and video content."

Structure of an Effective Case Study

Results

- Showcase the outcomes of your efforts. Use numbers or data to illustrate success (e.g., follower growth, engagement rates, or sales).
- Example: "As a result, the client saw a 50% increase in followers and a 30% rise in post engagement within 3 month

Relevant Work Samples



Highlight Your Core Skills

Choose projects that best represent your strongest skills. Focus on what you're most proud of and where you've delivered the highest impact.

Match Projects to the Industry

Select work that demonstrates experience relevant to your audience's industry. If applying for a role in tech, showcase digital projects or social media campaigns for tech brands.

Curate Selectively

Instead of showcasing everything, pick a few of your best projects that align with the job or clients you are aiming for. Fewer, stronger examples make a better impression.

Relevant Work Samples



Display Versatility

Select a mix of projects that demonstrate different skills or capabilities. This can be particularly helpful if you're a freelancer or generalist.

Include Results or Impact

Select work that not only shows your creativity or technical skill but also highlights the impact you made. Use metrics to support your case (e.g., increased engagement, higher sales).

What if I don't have any work history or sample?

- Build work samples
- Take up dummy projects, ask ChatGPT to give you tasks,
- Take up internships no matter how long
- Take a lot of courses i.e Udemy, Coursera

Questions and Answers

Send it to the host directly or Unmute yourself and ask

